

Sunil Pathak, director, human resources, Cadence Design Systems (I), informs, "The semiconductor industry grew at a rate of around 20 per cent last year. Even in the current scenario, I assume that the semiconductor industry would grow at about 10-15 per cent, which is also a considerable rate of growth. With the growth in semiconductor and VLSI industries in India, demand for product design and CAD engineers is definitely growing."

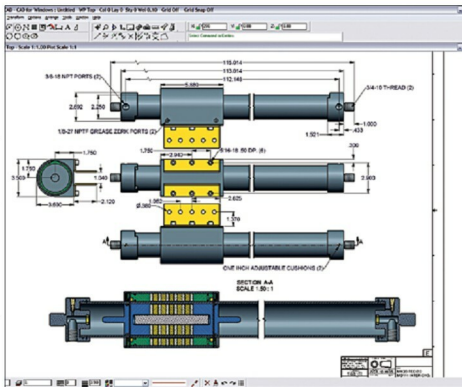
You can work anywhere and everywhere

There is scope for product design engineers in almost every industry, asserts Prof. G.G. Ray, head of Industrial Design Centre, IIT Bombay. Prof. Ray, however, feels that it is incorrect to call product designers as product design engineers. "I agree that this is an advanced branch of engineering but it is more than just engineering. It is a creative process. So engineers who lack creativity and out-of-the-box thinking are not suited for this profession," he explains.

Creativity is definitely important to get into this profession. Industrial Design Centre at IIT Bombay, India's premier institute teaching product design, has a selection criteria where candidates' creativity, and artistic and aesthetics sense are also judged at the time of admission.

Prof. Ray cites an example from automotive sector: "For automobile design, companies look for candidates who can visualise what a car should look like in the future. The visualisation part is not where much of engineering is required. One has to be artistic and a great visualiser. He should know how cars looked like in the past and what is the form of vehicles today. Considering the changes observed, he should be able to visualise what cars should look like in the future. Having an engineer's mind is an added advantage because it helps in visualising objects, which can be converted into reality."

So if you have a knack for foresee-



CAD for product design (Courtesy: www.cadinternational.com)

Some companies where you can fit into

1. Consumer electronics companies like Samsung, LG, Whirlpool, Voltas and Godrej
2. Semiconductor companies like STMicroelectronics, Infineon, NXP Semiconductors and Qualcomm
3. Electronics system companies (which do system design and PCB design) like Freescale, STMicroelectronics and NXP Semiconductors
4. Telecom companies like Huawei, ZTE, Samsung and LG

ing the future, you are bound to succeed in this field.

There is immense growth too

In product design, sky is the limit for you. Nitin Jain, head-marketing, presales & solutions, highlights the growth path for an engineer willing to make career in product design: "A product design engineer can grow as much as he wants. There is always an adequate demand for such professionals and, being in the niche segment, companies are always keen to hire people with exceptional talent. A fresher in this domain can grow to the highest level in the company."

Explaining further, Kapur says, "A fresher can join a company like Broadcom as a product design engineer and

grow up to a level parallel to the highest rank being offered in the company. So the growth opportunities are immense. With India becoming a major electronics player, opportunities for product design engineers are increasing manifold."

Attractive offers

If you are the lucky one with a knack for design and technology, you will get well-paid for your abilities. Of course, pay packages vary from industry to industry, but product design engineers can get an average starting salary of Rs 400,000 to Rs 800,000 per annum. In fact, there are companies that do not mind giving handsome perks to such valuable employees. ●

The author is an assistant editor at EPY